GLASSHOUSE

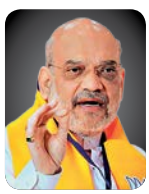


Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

SWEET OVERTURE

Come summer and West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee sends the choicest mangoes from the state's orchards to the high and mighty of the country. There is a new name on her list this year—D.Y. Chandrachud, Chief Justice of India. While no one knows if Didi extended such charity to the CJI's predecessors, Opposition leaders are wondering if this comes under inappropriate conduct, as the apex court is hearing some important cases involving the Trinamool Congress government. But then Mamata sees no friend or foe when it comes to sharing the sweetness from Bengal, be it rosogullas or mangoes. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, one of her fiercest rivals, is a regular recipient.

Spectrum of Corruption



While the 2G scam may have led to the fall of the United Progressive Alliance government, it wasn't the spectrum scandal Union home minister **Amit Shah** was alluding to when at an event in Tamil Nadu, he termed the DMK and the Congress—allies in the UPA when the 2G scam allegedly took place—as the 2G, 3G, 4G parties. "I am not talking about the 2G spectrum scam," he clarified. "2G means two generations, 3G means three generations and 4G means four generations...the Maran family has been doing corruption for two generations, the Karunanidhi family has been doing corruption for three generations, the Gandhi family is 4G. Rahul Gandhi is fourth-generation. For four generations, they have enjoyed power."

All Heads Together



When Congress president **Mallikarjun Kharge** expressed his inability to attend the meeting of all Opposition leaders Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar convened in Patna on June 12 and reportedly offered to send someone else instead, the meeting was immediately called off and rescheduled for June 23. Unwilling to make it look like another half-hearted attempt at Opposition unity, Nitish made it clear that "all parties must be represented by their respective heads". Hint taken, the Congress high command, within 72 hours, confirmed the participation of not just Kharge but also Rahul Gandhi.



Poaching Wars

Despite being in alliance, the BJP and AIADMK have clashed over mutual poaching since early 2023. On June 9, the saffron party scored a big win when it ensured the return of **V. Maitreyan**, an oncologist and Jayalalithaa acolyte, to the saffron fold after two decades in the AIADMK. Thrice a member of the Rajya Sabha, Maitreyan comes back at a time when the party is looking to project itself as a serious contender in Tamil Nadu politics. The only problem? Its alliance with the Dravidian major may be rockier than ever before.

A Growing List

The assembly election in Maharashtra may be a year away, but the number of chief ministerial aspirants across parties is rising. In addition to the incumbent Eknath Shinde, his deputy and BJP leader Devendra Fadnavis, Shiv Sena leader Uddhav Thackeray and NCP leader Ajit Pawar, their supporters pitchforked two more leaders into this league by putting up banners on their birthdays—state Congress chief Nana Patole and Maharashtra Navnirman Sena president **Raj Thackeray**. Now to see if a complete dark horse wins this race.



MILIND SHELTE

Kaushik Deka with Romita Datta, Amitabh Srivastava, Dhaval Kulkarni and Amarnath K. Menon